

Client Onboarding and Service Playbook

Demo operations guide for inquiry handling, onboarding controls, and service SLAs

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Applies To	Sales desk, onboarding, client service, and operations support teams

Document Purpose

- Provide unstructured process guidance for handling client inquiries and onboarding dependencies.
- Support hybrid demos where structured account entitlements are combined with process explanations.
- Define response expectations, escalation, and exception procedures for service workflows.

This is synthetic demo content for retrieval and hybrid reasoning testing. Values, thresholds, and names are illustrative only.

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1. Operating Model and Roles

- Sales Desk captures inquiry context, client identifier, and urgency.
- Client Service validates account details and routes standard information requests.
- Onboarding Team manages KYC, documentation, and account activation dependencies.
- Operations Team validates operational cutoffs, settlements, and processing feasibility.
- Risk Control reviews exceptions, restricted list flags, and limit overrides.

Role	Primary Responsibility	Typical Output
Sales Desk	Intake and clarification	Structured request with ticker, quantity, term, account_id
Client Service	Status and entitlement validation	Customer-ready response or escalation
Onboarding	KYC and account activation	Approved / pending / on hold status update
Operations	Execution feasibility and cutoffs	Processing timeline and operational caveats
Risk Control	Exception and restriction review	Approval, decline, or reduced limit

2. Onboarding Workflow and KYC Prerequisites

No executable borrow or subscription confirmation should be provided until onboarding prerequisites are satisfied.

- KYC status must be approved for transactional responses.
- Pending KYC may receive informational responses with clear next steps.
- Expired KYC should be routed to refresh workflow before transactional support.
- Onboarding status should be active before confirming account-level eligibility.
- Missing legal or tax documentation may place an account on hold.

Prerequisite	Evidence	If Missing
KYC approval	Approved status in client entitlement	Reject to onboarding and mark response as informational
Account activation	Onboarding status = active	Do not provide executable confirmation
Tax documentation	Valid forms on file (demo placeholder)	Request updated forms via onboarding team
Authorized contacts	Approved contact list	Limit disclosures until identity verified

Recommended wording for pending KYC: 'We can share general information, but transactional availability or account-specific processing cannot be confirmed until KYC approval is complete.'

3. Inquiry Triage and Routing Rules

- Classify inquiry as structured, unstructured, or hybrid at intake.
- Structured examples: availability, quantity, rate, fee, minimum investment, status.
- Unstructured examples: policy definitions, constraints, process timing, required documents.
- Hybrid examples combine factual values with policy or process explanations in one request.
- If account_id is not provided for account-specific questions, return a general answer plus a request for account details.

Inquiry Type	Example	Routing Pattern
Structured	'Do we have 1M AAPL available today?'	Inventory + entitlement check
Unstructured	'What does indicative rate mean?'	Policy/FAQ retrieval
Hybrid	'AAPL availability and constraints?'	Inventory + entitlement + policy retrieval
Hybrid	'Fund minimum, fees, and eligibility?'	Fund master + account entitlement + FAQ retrieval

4. Service SLAs and Response Targets

- Priority classification should be based on client tier, request urgency, and market cutoff proximity.
- Responses should acknowledge receipt before cutoff if full answer requires multiple teams.
- Informational responses can be provided while transactional checks are pending, provided caveats are clear.

Service Level	Initial Acknowledgment	Target for Standard Info Response	Escalation Trigger
standard	Within 2 business hours	Same business day	Missed cutoff risk or dependency unresolved
priority	Within 1 business hour	Within 4 business hours	Client deadline within same day
platinum	Within 30 minutes	Within 2 business hours	Any blocker on critical request

SLA clock pauses only when the team is waiting on required client information and the dependency has been explicitly communicated.

5. Exception Handling and Approvals

- Exceptions may include borrow limit override requests, fund access exceptions, or cutoff extensions.
- Each exception ticket should include client_id, account_id, request details, business rationale, and requested decision time.
- Approvals must be documented with approver name, timestamp, and scope (quantity, term, duration, or product).
- Temporary overrides should include expiry date and review owner.
- Declines should include a concise reason and, where possible, an alternative path.

Exception Type	Approver	Typical Decision
Borrow size above account cap	Risk Control + Desk Manager	Approve reduced quantity, approve temporary override, or decline
Soft-closed fund access request	Product Management + Compliance (conditional)	Conditional approval or decline
Post-cutoff same-day processing	Operations Lead	Best effort only or next-day scheduling

6. Communication Templates

Template A - Hybrid availability plus policy response

- Confirm the structured result first (availability, quantity, rate, fee, minimum, status).
- Then state the relevant constraint (KYC, client cap, share class eligibility, cutoff).
- Close with next step and any missing information required for final confirmation.

Template B - Pending onboarding dependency: 'Thank you for your request. We can share general product and market information at this time. Final account-specific confirmation requires completion of onboarding/KYC review. Please share account_id or confirm authorized contact details and we will proceed.'

Template C - Reduced-size alternative

If inventory supports the request but account controls do not, offer a reduced quantity and cite the applicable cap.
Example: 'We currently see 1.25M shares available, however your account cap for a single security is 750K shares. We can support 750K subject to standard cutoff and confirmation.'

7. Controls, Audit Notes, and Issue Logging

- Log inquiry type, source channel, timestamps, and responder.
- Capture which datasets and policy documents were referenced in the response.
- Record whether response was informational, indicative, or executable confirmation.
- Store exception approvals and expiry timestamps for audit traceability.
- Tag recurring issues (for example missing account_id, pending KYC, restricted sector) for process improvement.

Issue Code	Description	Suggested Action
INFO-001	Missing account identifier	Request account_id and provide general guidance
KYC-002	KYC pending or expired	Route to onboarding; no executable confirmation
LIM-003	Borrow cap exceeded	Offer reduced size or exception process
FUND-004	Share class ineligible	Suggest eligible share class or escalate
OPS-005	Cutoff missed	Queue next-day processing or request escalation

8. FAQ and Support Scenarios

Question	Response Summary
Can we answer without account_id?	Yes for general market or product info, but account-specific constraints need account_id.
Can we quote a firm rate before KYC approval?	No. Provide informational or indicative guidance only.
What if the client asks for both fund fees and borrow availability?	Use hybrid multi-domain request and route to the relevant datasets plus policy docs.
How do we handle soft-closed funds?	Explain status and collect details for approval review if appropriate.
What should be logged for audit?	Inquiry details, data sources used, response type, and any approvals or exceptions.

Support Scenario Examples

- Scenario 1 - Client asks for Northern Trust Global Real Estate Index Fund minimum investment and fee structure. Use fund master for values and FAQ policy for definitions and eligibility caveats.
- Scenario 2 - Client asks for 1M shares of AAPL plus constraints. Use inventory for availability and rate, entitlements for account cap, and securities lending policy for cutoff and indicative rate caveat.
- Scenario 3 - Client requests execution while onboarding is in progress. Provide informational response and route to onboarding team with required documents checklist.